ADVANCED PROMPT ENGINEERING FOR JOURNALISTS

Final project

Build a CLI workflow that solves a real problem in your journalism practice

Optional — not required for your certificate

Joe Amditis | Center for Cooperative Media | Knight Center MOOC

REQUIREMENTS

Your project must meet four criteria

1 **Use a CLI AI tool**
Claude Code, Gemini CLI, Codex CLI, or another CLI tool with instructor approval

2 **Include automation**
Go beyond a single prompt: a reusable script, multi-stage pipeline, scheduled task, or custom skill

3 **Solve a real problem**
Address an actual challenge: something you do manually, avoid because it's tedious, or that needs better consistency

4 **Include documentation**
A README explaining the problem, setup, usage, expected output, and limitations

Submit a **GitHub repository** or **zip file** with all code, config files, a README, and sample input/output.

INSPIRATION

Suggested project ideas

Newsletter pipeline
Gather beat content, summarize developments, draft newsletter sections as reusable weekly output

Transcript processor
Extract key quotes, identify themes, generate structured research documents from interview audio

Source verification
Encode your fact-checking process into a skill: check claims, document sources, flag what needs confirmation

Social content generator
Take a published story and produce platform-specific posts, threads, and newsletter blurbs

Meeting notes processor
Extract action items and newsworthy decisions from city council, school board, or public meetings

Public records pipeline
Clean and standardize messy public records (PDFs, spreadsheets, text files) for analysis

Custom beat skill
Build a specialized skill for your coverage area with domain knowledge and recurring task automation

or invent your own →

These are starting points. Adapt them to your beat or invent something new.

TIMELINE & SUBMISSION

How to submit your project

WEEK 2	WEEKS 3 – 4	END OF WEEK 4
Project proposal	**Build your workflow**	**Submit final project**
Share your idea	Use office hours for help	Forum or Google Form

SUBMISSION OPTIONS

1. **Discussion forum**
   Share your project publicly so other journalists can learn from it
2. **Google Form**
   Submit privately if you prefer not to share publicly

GETTING HELP

- Post questions in the discussion forum
- Attend live office hours (Weeks 2–4)
- Share work-in-progress for peer feedback
- Review the example projects document

We encourage you to share your work — it helps other journalists see what's possible.